

Wookhyun Kwon

Composer | Instructor · Based in Chicago and Seoul · laceykwon@gmail.com

Education

2023–	PhD in Composition and Music Technology, <i>Northwestern University</i> , studied with Hans Thomalla; guidance under Jay Alan Yim, Alex Mincek and Stephan Moore
2020–23	MM in Composition, <i>Manhattan School of Music</i> , studied with Marjorie Merryman, Nirmali Fenn and Reiko Fueting
2013–17	BM in Composition, <i>Kookmin University</i>

Commissions and Collaborations

2027	Collaboration with Ian Antonio (percussion, <i>Wet Ink Ensemble</i>), Evanston (forthcoming)
2026	Collaboration with <i>Duo Tesserae</i> (violin, piano), @DiMenna Center, New York City (forthcoming)
2026	Collaboration with the Contemporary Music Ensemble (CME), @Galvin Hall, Evanston (forthcoming)
2025	Collaboration with <i>PART Ensemble</i> , @Lutheran Church, San Antonio
2025	Collaboration with <i>Unheard-of Ensemble</i> , @McNay Art Museum, San Antonio
2025	Collaboration with Rowan Jones (clarinet), @Internationales Musikinstitut Darmstadt (IMD)
2025	Collaboration with Josh Modney (violin, <i>International Contemporary Ensemble</i>), @Regenstein MCR, Evanston
2024	Commissioned by <i>Con:Trust</i> (accordion duo), part of <i>Unerhörte Musik</i> , @Tenri Cultural Institute, New York City and @BKA-Theater, Berlin
2024	Collaboration with <i>Masso Saxophone Quartet</i> , recording session @Northwestern University
2022	Collaboration with Emmalie Tello (clarinet, <i>International Contemporary Ensemble</i>), @Greenfield Hall, New York City
2021	Collaboration with a joint ensemble of <i>Manhattan School of Music</i> and <i>Hochschule für Musik Franz Liszt Weimar</i> , performed in New York City, Weimar, and Magdeburg
2020	Collaboration with <i>Windscape Ensemble</i> , part of their project <i>You give us 26 minutes...</i> (virtual performance)
2019	Collaboration with Jihyun Park (violin, <i>Hwaum Chamber Orchestra</i>), @Alternative Space LOOP, Seoul
2019	Collaboration with <i>Wiro Ensemble</i> , Seoul

Residencies, Workshops and Festivals

2027	Selected Composer, <i>precept.concept.percept XVII</i> , Slovenia
2025	Selected Composer, Collaborative Composition Initiative (CCI) Workshop, San Antonio, individual sessions with Juri Seo and Annika Socolofsky · Info
2025	Selected Participant, Clarinet Workshop, <i>Internationales Musikinstitut Darmstadt (IMD)</i> , individual sessions with George Lewis, Clara Iannotta and Malin Bång; workshop led by Heather Roche and Hans Thomalla · Info

2021 Selected Composer, collaborative project with *Hochschule für Musik Franz Liszt Weimar* and *Manhattan School of Music*, four performances, New York City, Weimar, and Magdeburg · [Info](#)

Honors, Awards and Fellowships

2023– Fellowship and Full Tuition Scholarship, *Northwestern University*

2020–23 MSM Scholarship, *Manhattan School of Music*

2019 First Prize, 30th *Eumak Journal Music Competition*, Seoul

2019 Selected Composer, Hwaum Project Academy, Hwaum Chamber Orchestra; *Echo Chamber: Sound Effect Seoul 2019* (supported by Arts Council Korea)

Teaching

2027 Instructor, Introduction to Music Theory II, *Northwestern University* (Spring Quarter, forthcoming)

2027 Instructor, Class Composition for Non-Majors, *Northwestern University* (Winter Quarter, forthcoming)

2026 Instructor, Introduction to Music Theory I, *Northwestern University* (Winter Quarter) · [Syllabus](#)

Additional Experience

2025 Graduate Assistant, Contemporary Music Ensemble, *Northwestern University*

2024 Graduate Assistant, Student Composers' Concert Management, *Northwestern University*

2023 Presenter, Composition Colloquium, *Northwestern University*

2021 Presenter, Composition Forum, *Manhattan School of Music*

2017– Private Instructor, Music Theory and Notation Software

2017–20 Concert Manager, *Harmonia*, Seoul, managing venue rentals, scheduling, rehearsal logistics, promotional materials, and on-site operations for weekly classical concerts

Work List

2026 *Cue* | flute, bass clarinet, horn, trumpet, trombone, percussion, piano, violin, viola, cello, and conductor
written for the Contemporary Music Ensemble (CME), @Galvin Hall, Evanston, October 23, 2026 (forthcoming)

2026 *Be Piano* | violin and piano
written for *Duo Tesserae*, @DiMenna Center, New York City, October 16, 2026 (forthcoming)

2025 *Yecheon* | flute, viola d'amore, organ, percussion, and choreography
written for the Collaborative Composition Initiative (CCI) Workshop, performed by PART Ensemble, @Lutheran Church, San Antonio, August 15, 2025

2025 *Idiomatic Redemption* | bass clarinet, violin, cello, and piano
written for the sculpture *Redemption IV* by George Schroeder, premiered by Unheard-of Ensemble, @McNay Art Museum, San Antonio, August 14, 2025 · [Info](#)

2025 *Greetings III* | solo B♭ clarinet
performed by Rowan Jones, clarinet, @Internationales Musikinstitut Darmstadt (IMD), Darmstadt, August 1, 2025 · [Info](#) · [Video](#)

2025 *Unfamiliaritic familiar unfamiliarity* | solo violin
written for and premiered by Josh Modney, violin (International Contemporary Ensemble), @Regenstein Master Class Room, Evanston, April 10, 2025 · [Info](#) · [Video](#)

- 2025 *Violin* | violin and electronics
original materials recorded and composed by Wooksoon Kwon, March 2025, Chicago · [Video](#)
- 2024 *If Our Words Were Whiskey* | saxophone quartet
written for and performed by Masso Saxophone Quartet, recording session, @Northwestern University, Evanston, April 18, 2024
- 2024 *Overlapped Ta-da Data* | accordion duo
commissioned and premiered by Con:Trust, @Tenri Cultural Institute, New York City, April 12, 2024; @BKA-Theater, Berlin, April 16, 2024, part of *Unerhörte Musik*; @St. Johannis-Kirche, Hitzacker, July 4, 2026, part of *ACHTELTON* · [Info](#) · [Info](#) · [Video](#)
- 2023 *If Our Words Were Whiskey* | string quartet
premiered @Ades Performance Space, New York City, May 1, 2023 · [Video](#)
- 2022 ± 1 | flute, alto flute, bass clarinet, percussion, piano, violin, two cellos, and conductor
premiered @Ades Performance Space, New York City, October 7, 2022 · [Video](#)
- 2022 *Greetings II* | bass clarinet and electric guitar
written for and premiered by Emmalie Tello, clarinet (International Contemporary Ensemble), and Hunter Somogie, electric guitar, @Greenfield Hall, New York City, April 26, 2022 · [Video](#)
- 2022 *Fancy Doubt* | orchestra
written as a Master's thesis, @Neidorff-Karpati Hall, New York City, April 8, 2022 · [Info](#) · [Video](#)
- 2022 *Greetings I* | solo bass clarinet
written for and premiered by Emmalie Tello, clarinet (International Contemporary Ensemble), @Ades Performance Space, New York City, April 2, 2022 · [Video](#)
- 2021 *Happening* | flute, clarinet, horn, piano, accordion, violin, viola, and cello
premiered by a joint ensemble of Manhattan School of Music and Hochschule für Musik Franz Liszt Weimar, November 13, 2021, and performed in Magdeburg and New York City · [Info](#) · [Video](#)
- 2021 *Live and let live* | B♭ clarinet and piano
premiered at *Decomposition*, a composers' collective concert, @Concert Hall, Kookmin University, Seoul, June 28, 2021 · [Video](#)
- 2020 *Let out your breath* | wind quintet
written as a part of the Windscape Ensemble project *You give us 26 minutes...*, virtual performance, May 4, 2021 · [Info](#) · [Video](#)
- 2019 *Bias* | solo violin
premiered by Jihyun Park, violin, @Alternative Space LOOP, Seoul, November 29, 2019; Selected Composer, Hwaum Project Academy; *Echo Chamber: Sound Effect Seoul 2019* (supported by Arts Council Korea) · [Info](#) · [Info](#) · [Video](#)
- 2019 *Rough Trio* | violin, viola, and cello
premiered by Wiro Ensemble, @Concert Hall, Kookmin University, Seoul, May 29, 2019; performed @Music Hall, University of Seoul, June 23, 2019; First Prize, 30th *Eumak Journal Music Competition*, Seoul · [Video](#)
- 2019 *Two* | tenor, viola, and piano
premiered by Wiro Ensemble and Jinpark Choi (tenor), @Concert Hall, Kookmin University, Seoul, May 29, 2019
- 2019 *Friction* | viola and inside piano
premiered by Wiro Ensemble, @Concert Hall, Kookmin University, Seoul, May 29, 2019